

Timber, bamboo and related products must meet the import conditions published in our [Biosecurity Import Conditions system \(BICON\)](#).

We have categorised the common types of timber, bamboo and related products below. This information will help you to find the most appropriate BICON case for your goods. Please open [BICON](#) and search for the relevant BICON case term, as detailed below.

Composite products must meet the import conditions relevant to all components.



Common names

Artificial plants, artificial trees, faux plants

Import conditions

Refer to [BICON](#) case: Artificial plants on natural stems

Description/uses

Artificial foliage or flowers attached to a natural wood stem. The stem may be with or without bark.

Biosecurity risks

The bark on the natural stems can carry insects and plant diseases. Natural stems may also be from prohibited plant species like apple or elm trees. In some cases, seeds (including wheat) and pine cones are attached to the stems for decoration.

**Common names**

Corkwood, Balsa

Scientific name

Ochroma pyramidale

Import conditions

Refer to [BICON](#) case: Timber and timber products

Products constructed wholly from balsa wood or with balsa wood as the sole wooden component are listed in this case under the [Table of Wooden Products](#).

Description/uses

Balsa wood is the finished product derived after kiln drying and milling wood from stems of *Ochroma pyramidale*. It is commonly used for insulation, life-rafts and model making.

Biosecurity risks

Balsa wood is a light, processed wood. Balsawood has lower biosecurity risks than other wooden products because its width is usually too thin for borer attacks.



Common names

Dried bamboo, bamboo laminates, bamboo veneers

Scientific names

Bambusa spp., Dendrocalamus spp., Phyllostchys spp. and related genera

Import conditions

Refer to [BICON](#) case: Bamboo products

Description/uses

Bamboo articles include fencing, poles, handicrafts, sticks, chimes, chopsticks, baskets, skewers, and other articles that are wholly or partly made of bamboo. Bamboo must be dried and not capable of propagation.

Bamboo laminates include highly processed products made from bamboo that have undergone manufacturing processes including shredding or stripping of the bamboo, boiling or steaming, peeling/veneering, kiln drying, followed by moulding/pressing. These can include bamboo flooring, strand woven bamboo board and bamboo kitchenware.

Some highly processed bamboo products are considered to present a low biosecurity risk. Refer to [Wooden or bamboo products](#).

Biosecurity risks

Bamboo articles, if not processed sufficiently, may contain boring insects, fungi, and other contaminants that have the potential to introduce exotic pests and diseases to Australia.

**Common names**

Cane and rattan products, cane and rattan furniture

Scientific name

Calamus spp. and related genera

Import conditions

Refer to [BICON](#) case: Cane and rattan articles

Description/uses

Cane and rattan products include cricket bat handles, furniture, kitchenware and mats, as well as bundles of prepared rattan.

Cane and rattan articles can often contain bamboo components. Bamboo must meet the conditions as stated in the [BICON](#) case Bamboo products.

Biosecurity Risks

Cane and rattan products are often manufactured in rural-based cottage industries that lack rigorous quality control mechanisms to address biosecurity concerns. Insects can be found in the stems. Bark presents a risk of carrying disease and spores.



Common names

Cork, granulated cork, processed cork

Scientific name

Quercus suber

Import conditions

Refer to [BICON](#) case: Cork and cork products

Description/uses

Highly processed products made from the outer bark of the cork oak.

Biosecurity risks

There are minimal biosecurity risks with processed cork. Unprocessed cork and large cork products have the potential to become infested with insect pests.

**Common names**

Wicker furniture, wicker baskets

Scientific name

Salix spp.

Import conditions

Refer to [BICON](#) case: Dried willow articles

For sawn Salix timber (timber from willow trees), please refer to the [BICON](#) case: Timber and timber products

Description/uses

Includes baskets, fencing, furniture and mats. Articles that also include other material such as wood, rattan, cane or bamboo must also comply with the import conditions for these components.

Biosecurity risks

As willow may contains bark, it presents a risk of carrying disease spores and the bark may mask the presence of insects feeding in the wood.



Common names

Thatching, fencing, screening, bark fencing, brushwood fencing, China fir, fireweed, burning bush, summer cypress, weeping baeckea, weeping coast myrtle, heather, ling.

Scientific name

Fencing and screening can be made from various plant material from different species, including:

- branches, with or without bark of *Cunninghamia lanceolata* (syn. *Belis lanceolata* and *Pinus lanceolata*), *Calluna vulgaris*, and *Bassia scoparia* (syn. *Kochia scoparia*)
- shrubs of *Baeckea frutescens* (Myrtaceae family)
- ferns of *Coniogramme* spp., *Dicranopteris* spp., *Gleichenia* spp., *Pteridium* spp., and *Pteris* spp.

Import conditions

Refer to [BICON](#) case: Fencing, screening material and blinds derived from plants

Description/uses

Parts of shrubs, trees, branches, and bark used to make fencing and screening.

Biosecurity risks

Consignments of dried plant material can contain bark and viable seeds that may be prohibited, restricted or diseased. Dried plant material may also be infested with insects, contaminated with soil, or carry fungal spores of biosecurity concern to Australia.

Importation of Myrtaceous timber into Australia poses a risk of introducing exotic pests and diseases, including guava rust or myrtle rust.



Common names

Grape vine products and decorations

Scientific name

Vitis spp.

Import conditions

Refer to [BICON](#) case: Grape vine articles

Description/uses

Articles made from the vines of *Vitis* spp. include Christmas decorations, baskets and other ornaments.

Biosecurity risks

Grape vine may carry exotic plant diseases or insects. The vine may be propagatable, which increases the risk of entry, spread and establishment of biosecurity risks.



Common names

Plywood, ply products, ply sheeting, Laminated Veneer Lumber (LVL)

Import conditions

Refer to [BICON](#) case: Timber and timber products

Products consisting wholly of plywood or LVL are listed in this case under the [Table of Wooden Products](#).

For timber and timber products imported as Break-bulk from New Zealand during the burnt pine longicorn beetle (*Arhopalus ferus*) flight season, please refer to the BICON case: Timber and timber products imported from New Zealand during Burnt Pine Longicorn (BPL) flight season.

Description/uses

Articles made solely from plywood, veneer or a combination of plywood, veneer and reconstituted wood.

Plywood sheets are typically made from veneers no more than 5mm thick. Complete sheets are usually no more than 35mm thick (6-7 veneers bonded together) and includes I-beams, I-joists and flat-pack modular homes.

LVL is an assembly of thin timber veneers laminated with adhesive, where the grain direction of the outer veneers and most of the other veneers are in the longitudinal direction. LVL is often fabricated as beams.

Products containing solid wood components must be imported as a [wooden manufactured article](#).

Biosecurity risks

The manufacturing process of laminated timber products and articles manages some biosecurity risk. However, plywood and LVL can attract timber pests when stored in an environment that favours them.

Plywood and substrates used for veneers have the capacity to absorb moisture and this may encourage infestation by pests.



Common names

Logs, poles, raw lumber

Import Conditions

Refer to [BICON](#) case: Logs, log cabins and oversize timber

For logs, log cabins and oversize timber imported from New Zealand during the burnt pine longicorn beetle (*Arhopalus ferus*) flight season, please refer to the [BICON](#) case: Timber and timber products imported from New Zealand during Burnt Pine Longicorn (BPL) flight season.

Description/uses

Refers to any oversize timber. which is timber that exceeds 200mm in all dimensions or where any internal points of the timber exceed 100mm from any surface of the timber.

Products can require further processing onshore or may be imported as a final product, such as log cabins, statues, totem poles and oversize furniture.

For timber that does not exceed 200mm in all dimensions, please refer to the [BICON](#) case: Timber and timber products.

Timber of the species *Cocos nucifera* exceeding 200 mm in all dimensions is prohibited entry into Australia.

Biosecurity risks

Timber that has undergone minimal processing presents an increased risk of infestation with insects and snails, contamination with soil, bark, seeds, plant material and animal residues.



Common names

Wine barrels, casks, barrels, staves, tanks and vats made from oak, chestnut hoops, chestnut rings

Scientific name

Quercus spp. (oak), *Castanea* spp. (chestnut)

Import conditions

Refer to [BICON](#) case: Oak barrels and chestnut bark hoops

For barrels used in alcohol production which do not contain chestnut bark hoops, please refer to the [BICON](#) case: Timber and timber products. These barrels are listed in this case under the [Table of Wooden Products](#).

For barrels used as homewares including garden ornaments, please refer to the [BICON](#) case: Timber and timber products. Barrels for this end use are considered [wooden manufactured articles](#).

Description/uses

Oak barrels are used in alcohol production. Chestnut hoops are decorative wooden hoops on wine barrels. Wine producers wrap the hoops around oak barrels to minimise physical damage, as a support or decoration.

Biosecurity risks

The manufacturing processes combined with the end use of alcohol production make oak barrels a low-risk commodity. However, wine barrels can become infested with insect pests such as borers.

Chestnut articles may host [Chestnut Blight](#), a serious disease of chestnuts that presents a significant biosecurity concern. The disease has devastated chestnut forests in North America and Europe.



Common names

Packaging, packing materials

Import conditions

Refer to [BICON](#) case: Packing materials and packaging of plants

Description/uses

It is preferred that nursery stock plants are imported bare rooted. Packing materials can be used as packaging around nursery stock to reduce the risk of damage during transit.

Packing materials may include buckwheat hulls, cardboard, charcoal, paper, cork, peat moss and sawdust amongst others. This is material forming part of the goods and should not be considered as general use non-commodity packaging used to support goods in international trade.

Read more about:

- other types of [timber and bamboo packaging](#)
- [preparing for import](#) and the requirements for non-commodity packaging.

Biosecurity risks

Packaging materials such as straw, hay and wood shavings can present a very serious biosecurity risk. These materials may contain insects, soil, viable weed and cereal seeds, plant and animal diseases, and other contaminants.

**Common name**

Pine cones

Scientific name

Pinus spp. and related genera

Import Conditions

Refer to [BICON](#) case: Pine cones

Description/uses

The conical or rounded woody fruit of coniferous trees, with scales that open to release the seeds. Pine cones are mainly used in Christmas decorations and floral displays.

Biosecurity risks

There is the risk of pine cones introducing animal diseases, plant diseases, insect pests, and viable prohibited and restricted plant seeds.



Common names

Charcoal, coal, wood pellets, fuel wood

Import conditions

Refer to [BICON](#) case: Plant derived charcoal, wood pellets, briquettes and firewood

Description/uses

Charcoal includes timber or other plant residues that have been fully carbonised at high temperatures under low oxygen conditions. Fully carbonised charcoal includes carbonised briquettes and pellets made from compressed wood, charcoal, lump wood charcoal (which is fully carbonised timber, coconut shell, bamboo or any plant derived origin), extruded charcoal and heat beads.

Wood pellets and briquettes are products made by extruding and pressing sawdust, wood powder or charcoal and pelletising into pellets, agglomerated logs, or briquettes.

Biosecurity risks

Charcoal that is not fully carbonised may contain bark and other biosecurity risk material such as insects of concern. Wood or agricultural waste that has undergone carbonisation or high-level processing (heating, pressing or pelletising under pressure) poses minimal biosecurity risk when effectively stored and packaged to further reduce any contaminants such as insects.



Common name

Plant materials embedded in plastic or epoxy resin such as resin-encased flowers in artworks, displays, bookmarks or coasters, surfboards with wooden cores, fins or stringers

Import conditions

Refer to [BICON](#) case: Plant materials embedded in a solid medium

Description/uses

Includes timber and bamboo articles that have been fully embedded in hard silicone, glass, fibreglass, catalysed hard plastics or similar compounds using heat, moulding or chemical processes. Embedded materials must be completely impervious to air or liquids and incapable of movement within the medium.

Biosecurity risks

Embedded plant materials pose a low biosecurity risk due to their manufacturing processes.



Common names

Plastic wood, chipboard, particle board, fibreboard, medium density fibreboard (MDF), high-density fibreboard (HDF), oriented strand board (OSB), chipboard, particleboard, laminated strand lumber (LSL)

Import conditions

Refer to [BICON](#) case: Timber and timber products

Reconstituted wood or wood plastic composite products containing no solid timber components is listed in the [Table of Wooden Products](#).

Description/uses

Products made with wood fibre, plant flour or wood granules (pallwood), containing a minimum of 30 per cent resin, polyethylene, polystyrene, polyvinyl chloride or similar. They have no recognisable signs of the raw plant materials used in their manufacture, and have blending, thermal mixing and extrusion steps incorporated into their manufacturing process.

Products made from a combination of reconstituted wood and wood veneer where the veneer is no more than 5mm thick. Includes chipboard, hardboard, medium- and high-density fibre board (MDF), oriented strand board (OSB), particle board, and masonite.

Products containing solid wood components do not fall within the Table of Wooden Products and must be imported as a [wooden manufactured article](#).

Biosecurity risks

Due to the manufacturing processes, reconstituted wood or wood plastic composite products containing no solid timber components pose minimal biosecurity risks.



Common names

Sawdust, woodchips, wood cellulose, wood flour, wood shavings, wood fibre, wood wool

Import conditions

Refer to [BICON](#) case: Sawdust and woodchips

Description/uses

Includes sawdust, wood fibre, shavings, chunks, and chips, wood flour and powder, items containing sawdust such as animal beddings, door snakes or stuffed toys, pieces of wood used in wine making (excluding staves, headboards and barrels), pieces of wood used in aquariums and terrariums, and any other timber by-products.

For products which have been processed further into wood pellets, briquettes or charcoal, please refer to [Plant derived charcoal, wood pellets, briquettes and firewood](#).

Biosecurity risks

High biosecurity risks are associated with sawdust products such as soil, other plant materials, animal residues or insect concerns that have been mixed or packed with the commodity. Wood chips, chunks or bits constitute the highest risk because they have undergone minimal processing.



Common names

Pallets, crates, dunnage

Import Conditions

Refer to [BICON](#) case: Timber and bamboo packaging

Description/uses

Refers to timber and bamboo packaging and dunnage imported as a commodity and subsequently used as packing material in Australia, including to export goods from Australia. Includes cases, crates, pallets, packaging made from plywood and veneer, bearers and blocks. This does not include decorative boxes or similar that are imported with a commodity and remain with that commodity when sold.

This BICON case does not apply to general use non-commodity packaging used to support goods in international trade.

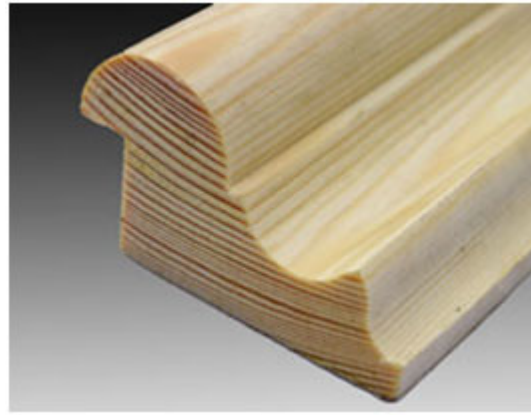
Read more about:

- [preparing for import](#) and the requirements for non-commodity packaging
- the types of non-commodity [timber and bamboo packaging](#)

Biosecurity risks

Timber and bamboo packaging and dunnage pose a high risk of introducing timber insects and plant pathogens into Australia. It is often made from lower quality timber that is not suitable for other commercial uses. Timber can have a high component of sapwood which is especially attractive to a wide range of timber pests.

Packaging containing solid timber must be treated with an approved treatment to mitigate biosecurity risk, for which certification in compliance with ISPM 15 is preferred. For further information, refer to the [ISPM 15: The international standard for solid wood packaging material](#) webpage.



Common name

Sawn timber, roundwood, glulam, cross-laminated timber

Import conditions

Refer to [BICON](#) case: Timber and timber products

For timber and timber products imported from New Zealand during the burnt pine longicorn beetle (*Arhopalus ferus*) flight season, please refer to the [BICON](#) case: Timber and timber products imported from New Zealand during Burnt Pine Longicorn (BPL) flight season.

Description/uses

Unfinished sawn timber that will be cut, modified or further worked in Australia e.g. in building and construction applications. Includes timber that is:

- rough sawn into a desired size
- machined into a desired shape and dressed (smooth surface) but is not finished (lacquered or painted) e.g. solid timber decking, flooring, glue laminated timber (glulam) and roof eaves.

Timber and timber products must have at least one dimension or a diameter that is less than 200mm. All internal points of the timber must be no greater than 100mm from the surface.

For timber that exceeds 200mm in all dimensions, or internal points exceed 100mm in depth, please refer to [Logs, log cabins and oversize timber](#).

Biosecurity risks

Sawn timber, roundwood and timber mouldings can become contaminated with mould, fungi, insects and other timber pests through storage on construction and building sites, shipping containers, and other environments. These products have the capacity to absorb moisture, and this may encourage infestation by pests.



Common names

Wisteria products, woven baskets

Scientific name

Wisteria spp.

Import conditions

Refer to [BICON](#) case: Wisteria articles

Description/uses

Articles that are wholly or partly made of wisteria, including baskets that are covered by wisteria binding and bundles of prepared wisteria.

Biosecurity risks

These products are often manufactured in rural-based cottage industries that lack rigorous quality control mechanisms to address biosecurity concerns. Insects can be found in the stems. Bark has a risk of carrying disease and spores.



Common names

Wooden products in their finished state, furniture, retail-ready flat packs

Import conditions

Refer to [BICON](#) case: Timber and timber products

Description/uses

Wooden articles are a finished product and are often lacquered, varnished or painted. Includes products that are new or antique, made from solid wood, or a combination of solid wood and plywood or veneer, plastic, glass or metal. This also includes items made by hand from wood, such as art, instruments, and any finished wooden items not listed in the [Table of wooden products](#).

For wooden products containing bark (including furniture, vases, bowls, picture frames, chopping boards and musical instruments), please refer to [Wooden manufactured articles containing bark](#).

Biosecurity risks

Due to their manufacturing, these products are considered low risk. However, they may still contain timber borers, insect pests, bark and other contaminants.



Common names

Art, décor and musical instruments featuring bark, furniture containing bark

Import conditions

Refer to [BICON](#) case: Wooden manufactured articles containing bark

Description/uses

Bark is the rough outer protective layer of stems and roots of woody plants such as trees, woody vines and shrubs. Bark is distinct and separable from processed timber.

Wooden articles where bark is a feature of the end product may include furniture, vases, bowls, picture frames, chopping boards and musical instruments.

Biosecurity risks

Bark poses a biosecurity risk to Australia as it creates a pathway for unwanted pests and diseases. Bark may mask the presence of insects feeding in the wood, plant pathogens, and other biosecurity risks from the environment in its structure such as spores and seeds within its cracks and crevices.



Common names

Highly processed wooden or bamboo products, including art and décor, venetian blinds and shutters, small household goods, toys and craft supplies, weapons, tool handles, and sticks used in perfume diffusers.

Import conditions

For timber products, refer to [BICON](#) cases: Timber and timber products

For bamboo products, refer to [BICON](#) cases: Bamboo products

Description/uses

Refers only to items outlined in the [Table of Wooden Products](#) and [Table of Bamboo Products](#) in their respective BICON cases. These products have undergone high levels of manufacture to mitigate biosecurity risk.

These tables exclude products containing bark, unfinished timber, and all other wooden or bamboo products not listed in their respective tables.

Biosecurity risks

Items listed in the [Table of Wooden Products](#) and [Table of Bamboo Products](#) have been assessed based on:

- processing and manufacturing techniques
- end use
- historical import data and trends
- common arrival modes and import volumes.

These factors, independently or in combination, have been determined to adequately reduce biosecurity risk to an acceptable level.

Further information

Read more about:

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/import/goods/timber/types>